

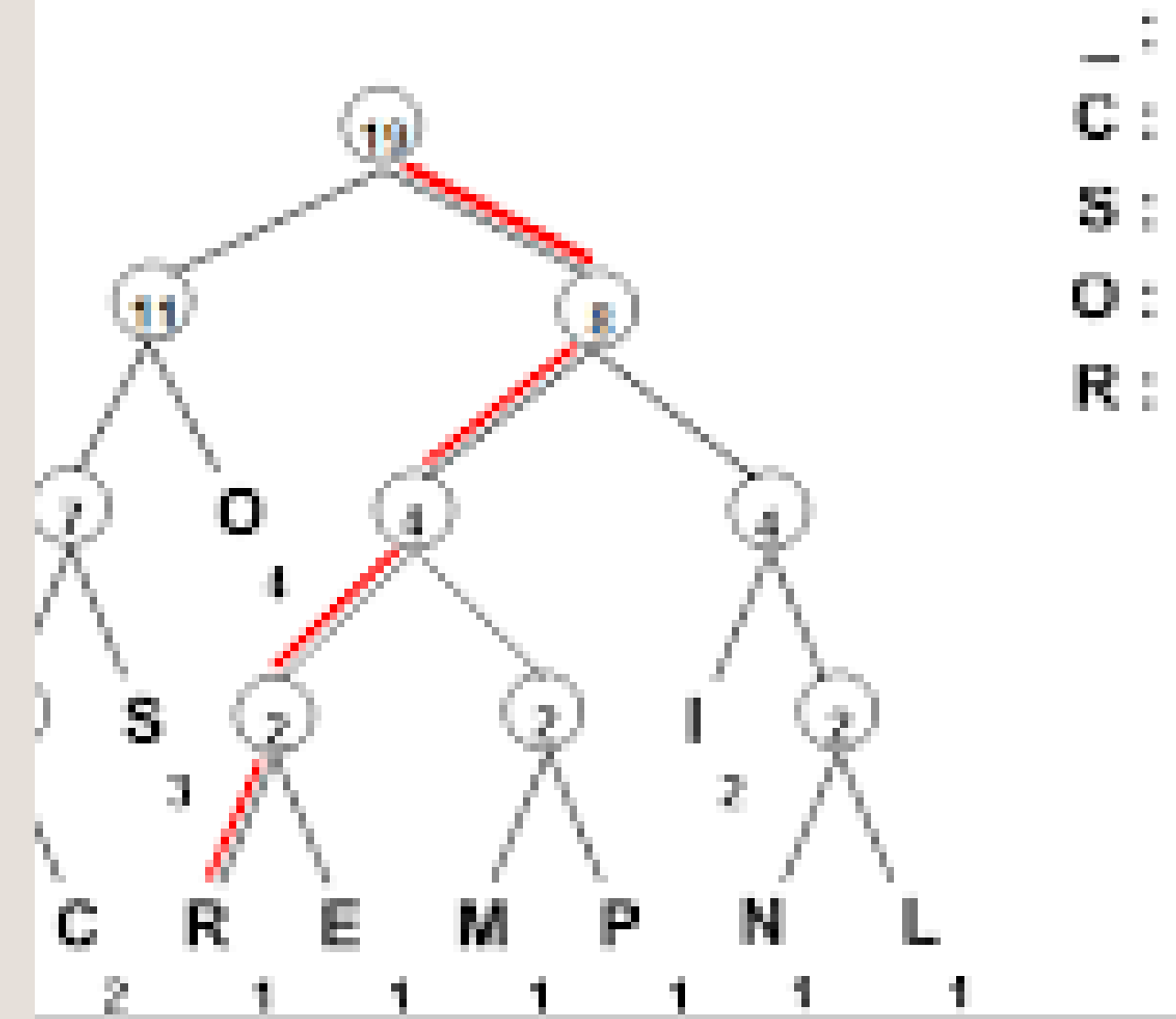
Image compression using huffman coding

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Huffman Coding

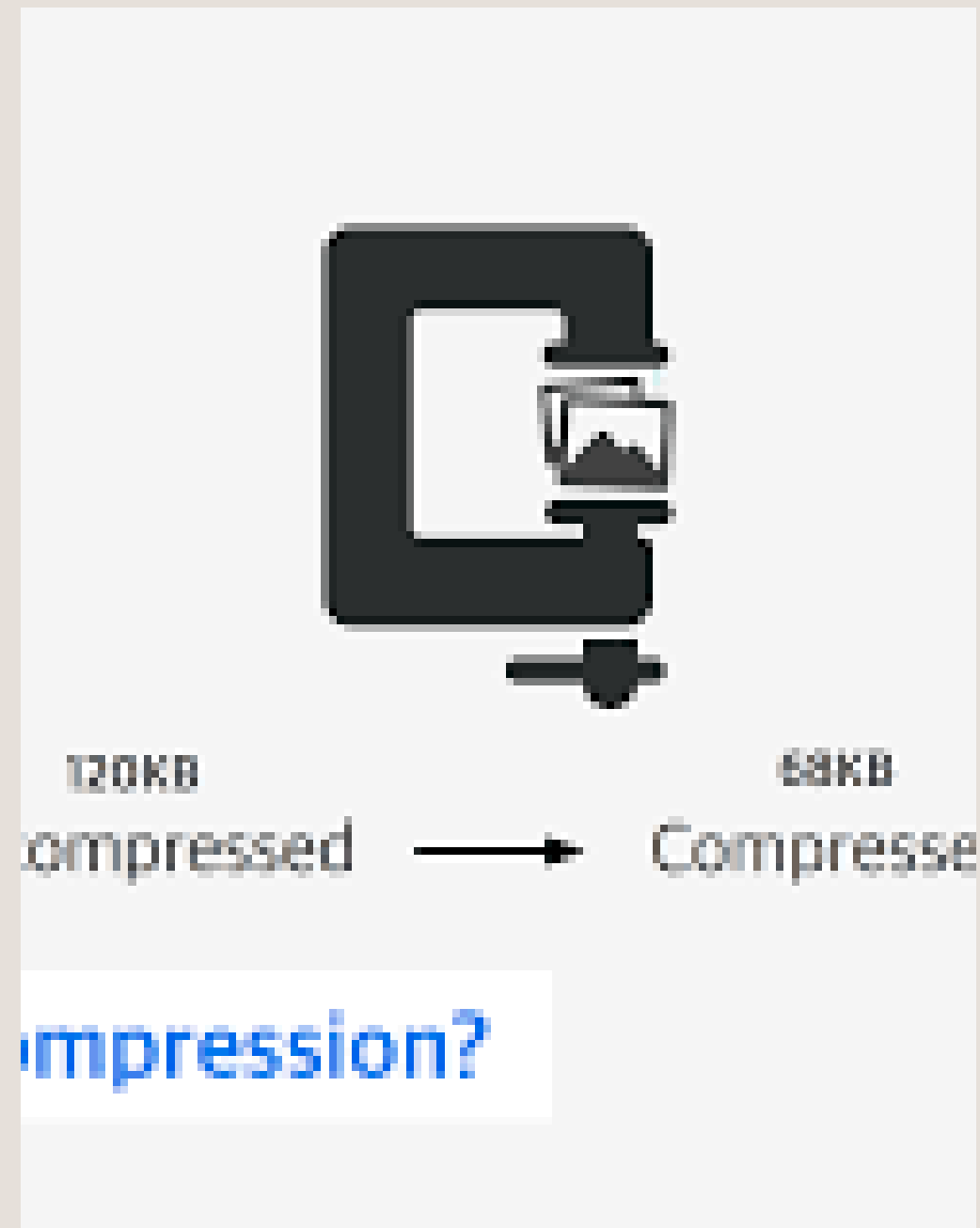
Example: "COMPRESSION_IS_COOL"

To find the bit pattern for each datum, we go up the tree and down a "1" (true) if we take the branch to the left, and a "0" (false) if we take the branch to the right, respectively.



Introduction:

Image compression using Huffman Coding is a method used to reduce video file size. It uses shorter binary codes for frequently used data and longer codes for less used data, helping to save storage space and increase transmission speed without losing data.



DEFINITION

Huffman Coding is a lossless data compression algorithm used to reduce the size of data by assigning shorter binary codes to frequently used characters and longer codes to less frequent characters.

It is based on the Greedy Technique.

CONCEPT FLOW

- STEP 1: UPLOAD / READ IMAGE
- STEP 2: CONVERT IMAGE TO PIXEL DATA
- STEP 3: REDUCE DATA
- STEP 4: COUNT FREQUENCY
- STEP 5: BUILD HUFFMAN TREE
- STEP 6: GENERATE HUFFMAN CODES
- STEP 7: ENCODE IMAGE DATA
- STEP 8: STORE / DOWNLOAD COMPRESSED FILE

MINI EXAMPLE

ORIGINAL PIXEL DATA:

SUPPOSE A GRAYSCALE IMAGE HAS PIXEL VALUES

255 255 255 128 128 64

FREQUENCY OF PIXELS:

255 = 3 TIMES

128 = 2 TIMES

64 = 1 TIME

HUFFMAN CODES GENERATED

255 → 0

128 → 10

64 → 11

COMPRESSED DATA

REPLACE PIXEL VALUES WITH HUFFMAN CODES

255 255 255 128 128 64

↓

0 0 0 10 10 11

COMPRESSED BINARY:

000101011

INPUT CODE

> output screensort

> uploads

✓ views

<> index.html

<> result.html

styles.css

{ } package-lock.json

{ } package.json

```
const multer = require("multer");
const fs = require("fs");
const path = require("path");

const app = express();

— Serve frontend files —
app.use(express.static("views"));

— Ensure folders exist —
const uploadDir = path.join(__dirname, "uploads");
const compressedDir = path.join(__dirname, "compressed");

[uploadDir, compressedDir].forEach(dir => {
  if (!fs.existsSync(dir)) fs.mkdirSync(dir, { recursive: true });
});

— Multer storage —
const storage = multer.diskStorage({
  destination: (req, file, cb) => cb(null, uploadDir),
  filename: (req, file, cb) => cb(null, Date.now() + "-" + file.originalname);
});
const upload = multer({ storage });

— MIME type map —
const MIME_MAP = {
  ".jpg": "image/jpeg", ".jpeg": "image/jpeg",
  ".png": "image/png", ".gif": "image/gif",
```


INPUT CODE

```
IN COMPRESSION

buildHuffmanCodes(data) {
  freq = {};
  forEach(val => { freq[val] = (freq[val] || 0) + 1; });

  // handle unique byte edge-case
  if (Object.keys(freq).length === 1) {
    const [val] = Object.keys(freq);
    return { codes: { [val]: "0" }, freq };
  }

  nodes = Object.entries(freq).map(([val, f]) => ({
    val: Number(val), f, left: null, right: null
  }));

  while (nodes.length > 1) {
    nodes.sort((a, b) => a.f - b.f || a.val - b.val);
    const left = nodes.shift();
    const right = nodes.shift();
    nodes.push({ val: null, f: left.f + right.f, left, right });
  }

  codes = {};
  function generate(node, code = "") {
    if (node.left === null && node.right === null) {
      codes[node.val] = code || "0"; return;
    }
  }
}
```

```
(bitStr) {
  padBits = (8 - (bitStr.length % 8)) % 8;
  bitStr = bitStr + "0".repeat(padBits);
  padded = [];
  for (i = 0; i < padded.length; i += 8) {
    bytes.push(parseInt(padded.slice(i, i + 8), 2));
  }
  paddedBuffer: Buffer.from(bytes), padBits };

// Write to file
const layout: Buffer = Buffer.concat([
  Buffer.from(magic),
  Buffer.from(s, 'uint8'),
  Buffer.from(n, 'uint32 BE'),
  Buffer.from(n, 'uint32 BE'),
  Buffer.from(JSON.stringify(freq), 'utf8'),
  Buffer.from(padBits, 'uint8'),
  Buffer.from(origLen, 'uint32 BE'),
  Buffer.from(freqJSON.length, 'uint32 BE'),
  Buffer.concat([magic, header, freqJSON, paddedBuffer])
]);
File({ freq, padBits, origLen, packedBuffer }) {
  // Write to file
  const header = Buffer.concat([
    Buffer.from("HUFF"),
    Buffer.from(JSON.stringify(freq), "utf8"),
    Buffer.alloc(9)
  ]);
  const magic = Buffer.from("00000000", "hex");
  const origLen = Buffer.alloc(4);
  const freqJSON = Buffer.alloc(4);
  const packedBuffer = Buffer.concat([magic, header, freqJSON, paddedBuffer]);
}
```

```
app.listen(3000, () => {
  log("HuffPress running on port 3000");
  log("http://localhost:3000");
  log("Routes loaded:");
  log("  POST /upload");
  log("  GET /image (preview image)");
  log("  GET /download-image (save image)");
  log("  GET /preview (decompress .huff)");
  log("  GET /download (save .huff)");

  log("Server error:", err);
  process.exit(1);
});
```

OUTPUT

Image Compression using Huffman Coding

Lossless

Fast

Secure

No Upload to Cloud

Upload your image to compress and reduce file size using the **Huffman algorithm**.

SELECT IMAGE

Drag & drop your image here
or click to browse files

JPG

PNG

GIF

BMP

WEBP

TIFF

Choose File

Compress Image

1 Upload

>

2 Huffman encode

>

3 Download .huff

Compression Successful!

Your image was decompressed and is ready to view & download.

Huffman Coding Algorithm

COMPRESSED IMAGE PREVIEW

Waterfall-landscape.jpg

0% smaller

69.19 KB

ORIGINAL SIZE

71.53 KB

HUFF SIZE

0%

COMPRESSION RATIO

—

SPACE SAVED

0% Space Savings

0%

0% Compression complete.

FILE DETAILS

ORIGINAL FILE

Waterfall-landscape.jpg

COMPRESSED FILE (.huff)

178218908597-Waterfall-landscape.jpg.huff

PROCESSED AT

5/8/2026, 11:11:48 AM

Download Image (original quality)

Download .huff file (compressed binary)

Compress Another Image

IMAGE COMPRESSION USING HUFFMAN CODING

CONCEPT FLOW

STEP 1: RECORD AUDIO

STEP 2: CONVERT AUDIO TO DATA

STEP 3: REMOVE EXTRA DATA

STEP 4: COUNT FREQUENCY

STEP 5: BUILD HUFFMAN TREE

STEP 6: GENERATE CODES

STEP 7: COMPRESS AUDIO DATA

STEP 8: STORE / TRANSMIT AUDIO

MINI EXAMPLE

ORIGINAL AUDIO DATA

A A A B B C

FREQUENCY

A = 3

B = 2

C = 1

HUFFMAN CODES

A = 0

B = 10

C = 11

COMPRESSED AUDIO DATA

000101011

ADVANTAGES OF HUFFMAN CODING FOR IMAGE COMPRESSION

1. Lossless Compression

No image data is lost

Original image can be perfectly restored after decompression

2. Reduces File Size

Frequently occurring pixel values get shorter binary codes

Helps reduce storage space and transmission time

3. Efficient for Repeated Data

Works well when images contain repeated or similar pixel values

4. Fast Encoding and Decoding

Compression and decompression are relatively fast

Suitable for real-time applications

5. Simple Algorithm

Easy to understand and implement

Ideal for educational and college projects

6. Improves Storage Efficiency

Smaller files require less disk space

7. Used in Real Compression Systems

Huffman coding is used in formats like:

JPEG

PNG (combined with other methods)

LIMITATIONS OF HUFFMAN CODING FOR IMAGE COMPRESSION

1. LIMITED COMPRESSION RATIO

COMPRESSION EFFICIENCY IS LOWER COMPARED TO ADVANCED METHODS LIKE:
JPEG

2. WORKS POORLY FOR RANDOM DATA

IF PIXEL VALUES ARE EVENLY DISTRIBUTED, HUFFMAN CODING GIVES LITTLE COMPRESSION BENEFIT

3. HUFFMAN TREE OVERHEAD

THE HUFFMAN TREE OR CODE TABLE MUST ALSO BE STORED FOR DECOMPRESSION
THIS INCREASES FILE SIZE SLIGHTLY

4. NO REDUNDANCY REMOVAL

HUFFMAN CODING ONLY ENCODES DATA EFFICIENTLY
IT DOES NOT REMOVE IMAGE REDUNDANCY OR UNNECESSARY INFORMATION

5. SLOWER FOR LARGE IMAGES

BUILDING HUFFMAN TREES FOR VERY LARGE IMAGES CAN INCREASE PROCESSING TIME

6. VARIABLE-LENGTH CODES

CODES HAVE DIFFERENT LENGTHS, MAKING IMPLEMENTATION AND DECODING MORE COMPLEX THAN FIXED-LENGTH ENCODING

7. NOT SUITABLE ALONE FOR MODERN COMPRESSION

MODERN IMAGE FORMATS COMBINE HUFFMAN CODING WITH:
TRANSFORM TECHNIQUES
QUANTIZATION
PREDICTIVE CODING

THANK YOU